



ILLUSTRATOR

JOB DESCRIPTION

Illustrators are commercial artists who produce paintings and drawings to accompany text in books, magazines, brochures, and advertisements. They usually specialize in a particular area, such as producing drawings for children's books, cartoons for newspapers, or technical illustrations for manuals. While some illustrators still use a pen or brush, many work on computers with special graphics software.



SALARY

Illustrator ★★☆☆☆

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Majority of illustrators work as freelancers • Volume and type of work subject to changing trends in media industries • Bulk of jobs available in print and online media

CAREER PATHS

There is no formal career path into this creative industry. You need to assemble a collection of your best work into a portfolio and present this to prospective clients. Your success depends not only on your artistic and technical skills, but also on your ability to promote and market yourself.

ASSISTANT You can gain useful experience and make potential industry contacts by working as a design assistant or technical artist within a media or publishing company.

GRADUATE An undergraduate degree in illustration, fine art, or graphic design offers employers proof of your skills. However, potential clients will judge your ability on the quality of your portfolio and its suitability for their needs.

CARTOONIST Uses their acute sense of humor and observational skills to draw cartoons or devise graphic stories. Their work may be used in newspapers, books, or magazines, or by advertisers to promote products.



ILLUSTRATOR Developing one of several artistic styles, you can find work through personal contacts or sign on with agents who promote your work and take a commission on any jobs they find for you.

